



EMBER THE BABY DRAGON

A chunky, big-headed baby dragon with a stubby snout, scalloped wings and a ridge of spikes down her back.

US Terms Intermediate	4–5 hours Finished size ≈ 11 cm	3.5 mm / E-4 Worsted #4 yarn
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Ember the Baby Dragon

Crochet amigurumi pattern · US terminology · worked in continuous spiral with two flat sections

A note on the design

A chunky, big-headed baby dragon with a stubby snout, scalloped wings and a ridge of spikes down the back. She sits, with folding haunches and splayed front legs. The head is left open at 18 stitches and ladder-stitched onto a matching 18-stitch neck — this is the most important structural detail and what keeps the big head from flopping.

Finished size

- **Height (seated):** about 11 cm (4.3 in) tall.
- **Wingspan:** about 12.5 cm (5 in).
- **Tail:** about 5 cm (2 in) long.
- A sitting dragon — her body rests on the table and her legs pose rather than lift her.

Materials

- **Main yarn:** Worsted #4, about 30 g used (buy a 50 g ball) — sage green, dusty teal, lilac or charcoal. The extra allows for tails, sewing and a second attempt.
- **Belly & wings:** Worsted #4, about 20 g in a contrast cream or pale gold.
- **Spikes:** Worsted #4, about 10 g in the contrast colour (horns, spikes and wings match).
- **Hook:** 3.5 mm (US E/4).
- **Eyes:** 2 x 10 mm safety eyes — slit-pupil dragon eyes if you can get them.
- **Also needed:** polyester fibre fill about 10 g, tapestry needle, stitch markers, pins.

Gauge

About **4.5 mm per stitch** and **4.3 mm per round**. Check on the body after Rnd 5 — 30 stitches should measure about **43 mm across** when stuffed. If your stitches are wider, crochet more tightly or drop to a 3.0 mm hook, or the stuffing will show through.

Abbreviations (US)

Abbr	Meaning
MR	Magic ring
ch	Chain
sc	Single crochet
hdc	Half double crochet
dc	Double crochet
inc	Increase — 2 sc in one st
dec	Invisible decrease
sl st	Slip stitch
FO	Fasten off
(n)	Stitch count at round end

Work in a continuous spiral unless a row says to turn; mark the first stitch of every round. The wings and the spike strip are the exceptions — both are worked flat, in turned rows. Work every stitch through both loops unless a note says otherwise.

1 · Head

Main colour · make 1 · worked top-down and LEFT OPEN

Do not close the head and do not fasten off. A big head is what makes a dragon read as a baby dragon. Two straight rounds only, then the decreases. Head and neck are BOTH left open at 18 stitches, so the two edges are the same size and can be ladder-stitched together cleanly — this joint carries all the weight of the head.

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
1	6 sc in MR	(6)	start
2	inc in each st around	(12)	
3	[sc, inc] x 6	(18)	
4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	
5	[3 sc, inc] x 6	(30)	
6	[4 sc, inc] x 6	(36)	head at full width
7	sc in each st around	(36)	eyes at R7–R8
8	sc in each st around	(36)	
9	[4 sc, dec] x 6	(30)	
10	[3 sc, dec] x 6	(24)	stuff firmly
11	[2 sc, dec] x 6	(18)	LEAVE OPEN

Finish

Stuff the head firmly. Leave the open 18-stitch edge for sewing to the body's neck (a long tail is optional). The snout is sewn on next, then the eyes, BEFORE the head is joined.

2 · Snout

Main colour · make 1

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
2	[sc, inc] x 3	(9)	
3	[2 sc, inc] x 3	(12)	
4	sc in each st around	(12)	
5	sc in each st around	(12)	

Finish

FO with a long tail and stuff lightly. Pin centred on Rnds 8–11 of the head, just below the eye line, and sew all the way around. It must project past the curve of the head, not sit flush — a dragon without a projecting snout reads as a bear. Embroider two small nostrils at the tip.

3 · Body

Main colour · make 1 · worked bottom-up

The neck is left open at 18 stitches so the head can be seated on it. Pack the neck firmly before you join the head — a soft neck is what lets the head flop forward.

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
2	inc in each st around	(12)	
3	[sc, inc] x 6	(18)	
4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	tail attaches R4–R6
5	[3 sc, inc] x 6	(30)	full width – check gauge
6	sc in each st around	(30)	back legs at R6
7	sc in each st around	(30)	
8	sc in each st around	(30)	front legs at R8
9	sc in each st around	(30)	
10	[3 sc, dec] x 6	(24)	wings at R10–R11
11	sc in each st around	(24)	
12	[2 sc, dec] x 6	(18)	stuff firmly
13	sc in each st around	(18)	LEAVE THE NECK OPEN

Finish

FO with a 40 cm tail; do not close. When you join the head, ladder-stitch all the way around and then make a second pass and pull it tight — this joint carries the whole head.

4 · Legs

Main colour · make 4 (2 back, 2 front)

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
1	6 sc in MR	(6)	all four
2	[sc, inc] x 3	(9)	all four
3	sc in each st around	(9)	all four
4	sc in each st around	(9)	all four
5	sc in each st around	(9)	all four
6	sc in each st around	(9)	BACK legs finish here
7	sc in each st around	(9)	front legs only
8	sc in each st around	(9)	front legs only

Finish & placement

Stuff the lower half lightly, flatten the top 3 stitches, FO with a long tail. The pairs are different lengths on purpose: back legs (6 rounds / 26 mm) attach at Rnd 6 of the body; front legs (8 rounds / 34 mm) attach at Rnd 8. A higher join needs a longer leg so all four feet reach the table. Sew each pair about 8 stitches apart; angle the back legs under as haunches and the front legs slightly forward. The body rests on the table — the legs pose, they don't lift her.

5 · Horns

Contrast colour · make 2

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
1	4 sc in MR	(4)	
2	sc in each st around	(4)	
3	[sc, inc] x 2	(6)	
4	sc in each st around	(6)	
5	sc in each st around	(6)	

Finish

Do not stuff; FO with a long tail. Sew to the crown of the head, 6 stitches apart, angled back.

6 · Tail

Contrast colour · make 1 · worked from the tip up so it tapers naturally

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
1	4 sc in MR	(4)	tip
2	sc in each st around	(4)	
3	[sc, inc] x 2	(6)	
4	sc in each st around	(6)	
5	sc in each st around	(6)	
6	[2 sc, inc] x 2	(8)	
7	sc in each st around	(8)	
8	sc in each st around	(8)	
9	[3 sc, inc] x 2	(10)	
10	sc in each st around	(10)	
11	sc in each st around	(10)	
12	sc in each st around	(10)	base

Finish

Stuff lightly, FO with a long tail, flatten the open end and sew it to the back of the body at Rnds 4–6.

7 · Wings

Contrast colour · make 2 · worked flat, in turned rows

Ch 11. Work in turned rows (ch 1 and turn at each row end).

Row	Instruction	Sts
Row 1	from the 2nd ch: sc in 4, hdc in 3, dc in 3	(10)
Row 2	sc in 3, hdc in 3, dc in 4	(10)
Row 3	sc in 2, hdc in 4, dc in 4	(10)
Row 4	sl st in first 2, (sc, hdc, dc, hdc, sc) in next st, sl st in next 2, (sc, hdc, dc, hdc, sc) in next st, sl st in last 4	(10)

The scallop maths. The slip-stitch anchors are $2 + 2 + 4 = 8$ stitches; the two shells each fan from a single stitch (2 more), so all 10 stitches of Row 3 are consumed and nothing is left over. Pin the straight inner edge across Rnds 10–11 of the body and sew the WHOLE edge so the scalloped edge stays free.

8 · Spikes

Contrast colour · one continuous strip · worked flat

One continuous strip sewn down the centre back from crown to tail tip. 10 units/spikes: 3 on the head, 4 on the body, 3 on the tail. Each group makes one small cone (about 10 mm tall); the last stitch of one group is where the next begins, so the spikes form one continuous ridge with no gaps. The strip is about 13.5–15 cm long — slightly under the crown-to-tail path, so it goes on slightly snug.

To make

Ch 4. Sc in the 2nd ch from the hook, then work this group **10 times: ch 4, sl st in the 2nd ch from the hook, sc in the next ch, hdc in the next ch.** Then sc in the next 2 and FO with a long tail.

Fitting

PIN it from crown to tail tip first; if it runs short add one more spike (about 13.5 mm), if long unpick from the plain end. The spikes deliberately touch — do not add plain stitches between them.

9 · Assembly

Work in this order

1. Snout to the head, centred on Rnds 8–11, below the eye line.
2. Eyes between Rnds 7 and 8, 8 stitches apart, just above the snout. Fit the washers BEFORE the head is joined — once closed you cannot reach inside.
3. Horns to the crown, 6 stitches apart, angled back.
4. Head to body — both edges open at 18 stitches. Pack the neck firmly, seat the head and ladder-stitch around, then a second tight pass.
5. Legs: back pair to Rnd 6, front pair to Rnd 8, angled as described.
6. Tail to the back of the body at Rnds 4–6.
7. Wings across Rnds 10–11, sewn along the whole straight edge.
8. Spike strip LAST — pin from crown to tail tip before you sew a single stitch.

Troubleshooting

- **Head flops forward.** Pack the neck firmly before closing and make the second ladder-stitch pass tight. If it still moves, the edges did not match — both head and neck must be open at 18 stitches.
- **Rocks back onto haunches.** The legs are all the same length and they cannot be. Back legs attach 26 mm up, front 34 mm up — work the back legs 6 rounds and the front 8.
- **Will not sit.** Legs sewn too high, or the base is under-stuffed. Back legs on Rnd 6, front on Rnd 8; keep the lower body firm enough to sit on.
- **Wings droop.** Sew along the whole straight inner edge, not just the top corner.
- **Spike strip is wrong length / curves.** It is ten chain-4 units worked end to end (not a single 40-chain). Pin the entire strip from crown to tail before sewing; add or unpick a spike as needed.
- **Looks like a bear.** The snout is missing or under-stuffed — it must project past the dome of the head.
- **Stuffing shows through.** Gauge too loose — 30 stitches should measure 43 mm across. Crochet tighter or drop to a 3.0 mm hook.

Safety & finishing notes

Ember uses **10 mm safety eyes**, which are a small part and a choking hazard. Lock the washers from the inside before the head is joined to the body, and pull-test each eye. She is a decorative piece, not a toy for young children, and has not been tested to ASTM F963 or EN 71. To give her to a child, embroider the eyes instead and check every seam first.

Colourways

Sage green · Dusty teal · Lilac · Charcoal · Blush pink

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